

CLOUD DATA SOLUTIONS ACCELERATOR PROGRAMME / WEEK 1 / DAY 1

Learner Self-Assessment

Skills baseline, career goals & capstone intentions — to be revisited at Week 8 and Week 16

WEEK 1 • DAY 1

ALL STREAMS

PORTFOLIO ARTIFACT

01 Your Details

FULL NAME

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COHORT / INTAKE

CDSAP 2026

DATE COMPLETED

2026/07/21

LINKEDIN PROFILE URL (OPTIONAL)

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02 Skills Baseline — Rate Your Current Confidence

1 — No experience 2 — Heard of it 3 — Some exposure

4 — Can do basics 5 — Comfortable

Be honest — this is not assessed. It is your personal baseline so you can measure your own growth at Week 8 and Week 16.

SKILL AREA	RATING (1-5)	NOTES / CONTEXT
Cloud computing concepts NIST, deployment models, service models	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☒ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5	Any relevant experi
AWS console & services EC2, S3, IAM, RDS, Lambda	☐ 1 ☒ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5	Any certifications o
Python programming Variables, functions, libraries, scripting	☐ 1 ☒ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5	Languages known, I
SQL & databases SELECT, JOINs, schema design, MySQL	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☒ 5	Database systems u
Git & GitHub Commit, push, branch, pull request	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☒ 5	How often do you u
Linux & command line Terminal, bash, file navigation, SSH	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☒ 5	OS you use daily...
Networking basics IP addressing, DNS, HTTP, firewalls	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☒ 4 ☐ 5	Any networking bac
Solutions architecture	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☒ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5	Any design experie

SKILL AREA

RATING (1-5)

NOTES / CONTEXT

System design, diagrams,
trade-off analysis

03 Career Path — Which Role Interests You Most?

Select the role that most closely matches where you want to be in 12 months.
This guides how you approach the programme and your capstone project.



CLOUD ENGINEER



AWS INFRASTRUCTURE, VPC
NETWORKING, IAC,
SECURITY, MONITORING

R650K - R950K AVG SA



DATA ENGINEER



PYTHON PIPELINES, SQL,
S3, RDS, DYNAMODB,
LAMBDA ETL

R600K - R900K AVG SA

SOLUTIONS
ARCHITECT

AWS SAA-C03, DESIGN
PATTERNS, COST
OPTIMISATION,
DOCUMENTATION

R800K - R1.2M AVG SA

DEVOPS / PLATFORM
ENGINEER

CI/CD, LAMBDA,
CONTAINERS, CLOUDWATCH,
AUTOMATION

R700K - R1.0M AVG SA

WHY THIS ROLE? WHAT DRWS YOU TO IT?

enjoy understanding how different technologies work together and
would like to design scalable, secure and cost-effective cloud
solutions. I am particularly interested in AWS and plan to work towards
becoming an AWS Solutions Architect while gaining practical

04 Your Goals for This Programme

WHERE DO YOU WANT TO BE IN 12 MONTHS? (CAREER-WISE)

I want to be working in a cloud-focused role with strong AWS skills, an established GitHub portfolio, and the AWS Solutions Architect Associate certification. I would like practical experience designing, deploying, and supporting cloud solutions.

WHAT DOES YOUR IDEAL CAPSTONE PROJECT LOOK LIKE?

I would like to build a cloud-native banking or financial analytics solution using AWS services such as S3, Lambda, RDS, IAM, and CloudWatch. The project should demonstrate architecture design, security, automation, and data processing best practices.

WHAT IS YOUR BIGGEST CONCERN OR CHALLENGE ENTERING THIS PROGRAMME?

My biggest concern is keeping pace as the technical content becomes more advanced. I am committed to learning and improving my skills in SQL, Python, cloud computing, and solutions architecture, but I know consistent practice will be important throughout the programme.



Your facilitator reads these. If you write down a specific concern, they can support you proactively. Be direct — this is a safe space for honesty.

05 Week 8 Revisit — Halfway Check-in

 **Complete this section at the end of Week 8.** Return to this form, fill in the fields below, save a new PDF named self-assessment-week08-[YourName].pdf, and commit it to your week08/ folder.

WEEK 8 REFLECTION COMPLETE AT WEEK 8

Re-rate yourself in the same 8 skill areas below. Compare to your Week 1 scores — where have you grown most?

SKILL AREA	WEEK 1 SCORE	WEEK 8 SCORE	WHAT CHANGED?
Cloud computing concepts	3	1-5	What did
AWS console & services	2	1-5	Which se
Python programming	2	1-5	What can
SQL & databases	5	1-5	What que
Git & GitHub	5	1-5	How has y
Linux & command line	5	1-5	Comman
Networking basics	4	1-5	VPC, subr
Solutions architecture	3	1-5	Can you c

WEEK 8 REFLECTION: WHAT HAS SURPRISED YOU MOST SO FAR?

Write 3–4 sentences about the most unexpected thing you've learned, and how your goal has shifted (if at all)...



06 Week 16 Revisit — Programme Completion

Complete this section at the end of Week 16, after your capstone presentation and before your exam. Save as self-assessment-week16-[YourName].pdf and submit to the Moodle final portfolio assignment.

WHERE YOU STARTED VS WHERE YOU ARE NOW — DESCRIBE YOUR TECHNICAL GROWTH IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Compare your Week 1 scores to now. Which skill area grew the most? Which was hardest? Write honestly — this reflection is part of your professional portfolio.

WHAT ARE YOU MOST PROUD OF IN YOUR CAPSTONE PROJECT?

Describe one technical decision you made in your capstone that you're proud of and why.

WHAT IS YOUR NEXT STEP AFTER THIS PROGRAMME?

e.g. 'Sit the SAA-C03 exam in the next 4 weeks, then apply for the cloud engineer roles I've bookmarked. My portfolio GitHub link is ready to share.'

WHAT ADVICE WOULD YOU GIVE SOMEONE STARTING THIS PROGRAMME TODAY?

Your best advice for the next cohort — based on what actually helped you.



How to Submit

This form does not submit automatically. Follow these steps to save and submit your self-assessment:

1. Complete all sections above (Sections 01–04 today; Sections 05–06 later).
2. Click **Save as PDF** below (or press **Ctrl + P** → select *Save as PDF*).
3. Name the file: `self-assessment-week01-[YourFirstnameLastname].pdf`
4. Save it to your local `cloud-data-portfolio/week01/` folder.
5. In your terminal: `git add week01/self-assessment-week01-*.pdf`
6. Commit: `git commit -m "[W1D1] Add Week 1 self-assessment"`
7. Push: `git push origin main`
8. Copy your GitHub file URL and paste it into the **Week 1 Portfolio Check-In** submission on Moodle.